Transfusion and cell recognition

'Jack is bleeding badly. He needs a transfusion.'

'Oh, he can have some of my blood.'

But Jack can't, unless his blood type is compatible with the donor's. The human body recognises blood cells. The **immune system** recognises all cells as either 'my cells' or 'invaders' and it attacks the invaders. **Cell recognition** is important for blood transfusions but also for organ and tissue transplants.

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the sentences below. One sentence is completely wrong – cross that one out.

Word bank

positive paramedics hurts good stitches anaesthetic chainsaw sample blood nurse

Casualty

Annie has sliced her arm open with a _____ while cutting firewood. At casualty, the _____ tell the doctor that she has lost a lot of _____. The doctor asks the nurse to get a blood _____ quickly to the laboratory. The trainee _____ puts *Iron Maiden* on the stereo because iron is _____ for the blood. The nurse comes back soon with a 600 ml bag of O _____ blood because the test showed that Annie was O positive. Two nurses quickly set up a transfusion of blood while the doctor _____ the wound.

'I bet that _____,' said the trainee.

'No,' said the doctor, 'I gave her an _____.'

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